

The Comet Mountain Solve

One mountain, one walk, one construction. East Pioneer Mountains, Beaverhead County, Montana. Consolidated September 14, 2026 from USGS elevation, roads, trails and hydrography, Posey's statements, his map, the book as reported, and the poem. Tags: POSEY his words or his map · DATA measured from USGS layers · READING analyst interpretation · UNVERIFIED community claim.

The solve in one paragraph. The poem's subject is a comet: a thing that lives in time and returns. "As hope surges, clear and bright" is Comet Mountain, over which the comet of hope, NEOWISE, rose in July 2020 as seen from Sawtooth Lake. Everything after that happens on that one mountain. The walk (stanza 2) follows the lakes under Comet, where the water runs silent under boulders, round the ridge past the cirque, to a trout lake. The construction (stanza 3) is drawn on a map: Comet is "he," east of Polaris; the bride is the lake standing in the granite gate of his south cirque, Dingley Lakes; from her foot, her outlet, a 20° line runs exactly to the outlet of Hopkin Lake in his north cirque, 1.27 miles; return it and you are looking at the place, Comet's north face, half a mile above Hopkin. Stanza 4 is the two cirques themselves, double arcs on granite, with Coolidge's mining past below. Stanza 5 closes the loop: Hopkin's water runs to Elkhorn Creek, Wise River and the Big Hole, which is Lewis's Wisdom River, so "Wisdom waits" from the first stanza is where the last stanza's river goes.

STANZA 1: THE FRAME

1:1 *Can you find what lives in time,*

1:2 *Flowing through each measured rhyme?*

1:3 *Wisdom waits in shadowed sight—*

1:4 *For those who read these words just right.*

READING A comet is the one natural object that lives on a schedule and comes back. Stanza 1 names the subject without saying the word; 2:1 gives it its adjectives. POSEY He has said the element of time is important, that numbers and names hide in the words, and that every line is helpful even before the first actionable clue.

DATA "Wisdom" is literal in the poem, not hidden. The Big Hole River was Lewis's Wisdom River, and it lies west of this crest, behind the West Pioneers. From Comet's summit the town of Wisdom is not in view; a ridge at 12.7 miles blocks the sightline. "Shadowed sight" as "just out of sight, in the range's shadow" fits that; "in plain sight" does not. This is the reading that must hold for the frame to close (see stanza 5).

DATA There is no hidden "comet," "polaris" or lake name spelled across the poem's letters, and the line initials spell nothing. The comet is carried by meaning, not by cipher.

STANZA 2: THE WALK

2:1 *As hope surges, clear and bright,*

COMET MOUNTAIN, 10,200 FT, 45.4597 -113.0443

- **READING** A comet surges: it brightens fast as it nears the sun and climbs the sky each night. It is clear, it is bright, and it has always been read as a sign. Hope is the human word for that.
- **DATA** Comet NEOWISE, called the comet of hope in July 2020, stood at azimuth 335 to 340 degrees, 4 to 5 degrees up, from Sawtooth Lake at 11 pm on July 10 and 11. Comet Mountain from that shore is at 343 degrees and 9 degrees up. The comet rose over the mountain named for one.
- **UNVERIFIED** Reddit: his 2020 Instagram photo tagged "Polaris" was taken at Sawtooth Lake. If it dates to July 10 to 20, 2020, this line has a witness.
- **POSEY** The treasure holds a meteorite. His map's only small Montana towns are Polaris (7 mi SW) and Dillon (26 mi SE), bracketing this crest; he said the labels were his choice and the map is a good primer. The book names Polaris and Crystal Park and describes the Grasshopper Valley sky as star-spangled. Solvable from home, as he said the first clue is.

2:2 *Walk near waters' silent flight.*

THE LAKES UNDER COMET: HALL, HOPKIN, ELKHORN

- **READING** A flight is a series, as in stairs or locks. Under Comet's north side the water steps down through Hall Lake (8,873 ft), Hopkin Lake (8,895) and Elkhorn Lake (8,691) into Elkhorn Creek. On the south side Dingley Lakes (8,885) drains west by Dingley Creek. Either is a flight of water; the north flight is the one the construction uses.
- **UNVERIFIED** Comet is described as eroded and boulder-strewn. Water under talus is silent. Field check where the Hopkin and Hall outlets go quiet.
- **POSEY** Walking distance from here through 2:3. **DATA** From the end of the mapped road on Comet's west shoulder (9,540 ft) it is 0.43 mi to the summit, 0.51 mi down to Hopkin's outlet, 0.32 to Hall's, 0.98 on to Elkhorn Lake's. Or 0.86 mi from the road end to Dingley's outlet. Every leg is inside his mile.

2:3 *Round the bend, past the Hole,*

ROUND COMET'S RIDGE, PAST HIS CIRQUE

- **POSEY** The Hole has no man-made implication, so it is not the Elkhorn Mine. He punted on whether it is a hole-named place. **DATA** Nothing named Hole exists within 10 miles; the nearest are fishing holes on the Big Hole River 14 to 21 miles away, not walkable.
- **READING** A cirque is a hole in a mountain. Comet has two: the south bowl holding Dingley Lakes and the north bowl holding Hall and Hopkin. "Round the bend" is rounding the ridge between them; "past the Hole" is passing the bowl. **DATA** The only measured 88° creek bend in the area is at Sawtooth Lake's outlet, two miles south, which belongs to the fallback path, not this one.

2:4 *I wait for you to cast your pole.*

HOPKIN LAKE, OR THE POLE STAR OVER POLARIS

- **READING** Hopkin and Hall are trout lakes; "I wait for you" is the lake, or him where he fished. **POSEY** He has not said the pole is a fishing pole. **READING** From the lake, the pole star stands over the town of Polaris, 7 miles south-west; "cast your pole" as "sight your pole star" is the setup for 3:1.
- **UNVERIFIED** Reddit: the book has him "cast his pole" at a badger on Grasshopper Creek, the west side of this range.

STANZA 3: THE CONSTRUCTION, FROM A MAP

POSEY Solvable from home; only Ursa East matters; "he" is alive or not by perspective; the bride is visible, not alive, and follows from the gates; the foot of three is readable without being at her; "return" is technically a rotation; her face is not far from the place; bride to treasure is a matter of perspective.

3:1 *In ursa east his realm awaits;*

DATA Polaris, the star of Ursa Minor, is a town on his map. Comet Mountain bears 30° from it, 7.2 mi. East of Polaris is this crest. **READING** "He" is Comet Mountain; his realm is the mountain and its two bowls. A mountain is alive or not "depending on your perspective," his exact answer.

3:2 *His bride stands guard at ancient gates.*

READING Nothing here is named for a bride or a gate, so she is a shape. A cirque lake sits in the mouth of its bowl between two granite walls the glacier cut: ancient gates. The lake stands guard in the opening, visible, not alive, and found only after you recognize the bowl, which is his "strange to find her without the gates." **Dingley Lakes** is the bride: the lake in the gate of Comet's south cirque, 0.85 mi from his summit at 184° from it.

3:3 *Her foot of three at twenty degree,*

DATA The foot of a lake is its outlet, readable on any map. From Dingley Lakes' outlet (45.44736, -113.04551, from USGS hydrography), a 20.0° bearing runs exactly to the outlet of Hopkin Lake (45.46465, -113.03653), 1.27 mi, climbing Comet's south-east flank to 9,807 ft and dropping into his north bowl. It is the only exact 20° between lake outlets in the basin.

Gap: "three." Dingley Lakes has a plural name but is one mapped pond with one outlet. The north bowl holds three lakes (Hall, Hopkin, Elkhorn) whose waters join in Elkhorn Creek, and the 20° line ends among them, so "three" may describe the destination rather than the foot. Or three feet is a yard. None is proven.

Gap: base rate. Nineteen outlet triples within 3 miles meet at 20° give or take 1.5°. The Dingley to Hopkin line is exact, single and on the right mountain, but geometry alone cannot prove it. The bride reading has to carry it.

3:4 *Return her face to find the place.*

READING A lake's face is its surface, and a lake returns a face: it reflects. Standing at Hopkin's outlet, where the 20° line ends, the returned face is Comet's north wall in the water. Turning to look at what the lake returns is the rotation he called "technically" correct. The place is that wall, 0.51 mi from the outlet at 228°, which is "not as far as many think," and how far the treasure is from the bride depends on where you stand on the shore, "a matter of perspective."

BOOTS ON THE GROUND FROM HERE

4:1 *Double arcs on granite bold,*

4:2 *Where secrets of the past still hold.*

4:3 *Beyond the reach of time's swift race,*

4:4 *Wonder guards this sacred space.*

- DATA Comet is Pioneer batholith granite. Its two cirques, the south bowl of Dingley and the north bowl of Hall and Hopkin, are two arcs cut in that granite, and the 20° line crosses from one to the other. Standing on the north wall, you are between the arcs.
- DATA Coolidge and the Elkhorn Mine sit 2.1 mi north down Elkhorn Creek: the past, held below. POSEY The site is not associated with buildings, mines or graves, so the past is something you look down on, not something you enter.
- READING "Wonder guards this sacred space": the ring of summits around the bowl, Comet, Saddleback, Sawtooth, Torrey. POSEY Something must be manipulated to see it; nothing significant is visible from 15 feet; no blaze on a tree. Expect a boulder-field placement on the north wall.

5:1 *Truth rests not in clever minds,*

5:2 *Not in tangled, twisted finds,*

5:3 *Like a river's steady flow—*

5:4 *What you seek, you already know.*

READING The warning stanza, and the frame closing. Hopkin's water leaves by Elkhorn Creek to Wise River and the Big Hole, which Lewis named the Wisdom River. The river that "waits in shadowed sight" in stanza 1 is the river the place drains to in stanza 5. What you seek, you already knew from the map: a mountain named Comet between the two towns he labeled.

THE RULES, AGAINST THIS PLACE

RULE	AT COMET'S NORTH WALL ABOVE HOPKIN LAKE	
Below 11,000 ft	Summit 10,200; Hopkin outlet 8,896	PASS
Public land, free, 24/7, dogs	Beaverhead-Deerlodge National Forest. Not verified with real PAD-US; Coolidge claims may be private	VERIFY
Within a mile of the car; a hike required	Road end 0.43 mi below the summit, 0.90 mi from Hopkin's outlet; the road is listed as a local road, not 4WD	VERIFY ON THE GROUND
Not near a trail	Hopkin 5,252 ft from the nearest mapped trail; the summit 5,846 ft	PASS
No buildings, graves, rails, caves, mines within 500 ft	None mapped within 5 miles; Coolidge's ruins and adits are 2 miles north	PASS
No climbing	Summit slope 8°; the north wall itself is steep, so the spot is at its foot or on its benches	CHOOSE THE BENCH
Within 75 mi of a Fenn site	94 mi to Hebgen Lake. Soft; he walked it back	FLAG
Not Colorado or Oregon; on the map	Montana, between Polaris and Dillon	PASS

RULE

AT COMET'S NORTH WALL ABOVE HOPKIN LAKE

More than a mile from family property

"Grandpa had a place" here per Reddit; location unknown

LOCATE

WHERE IT IS WEAK, HONESTLY

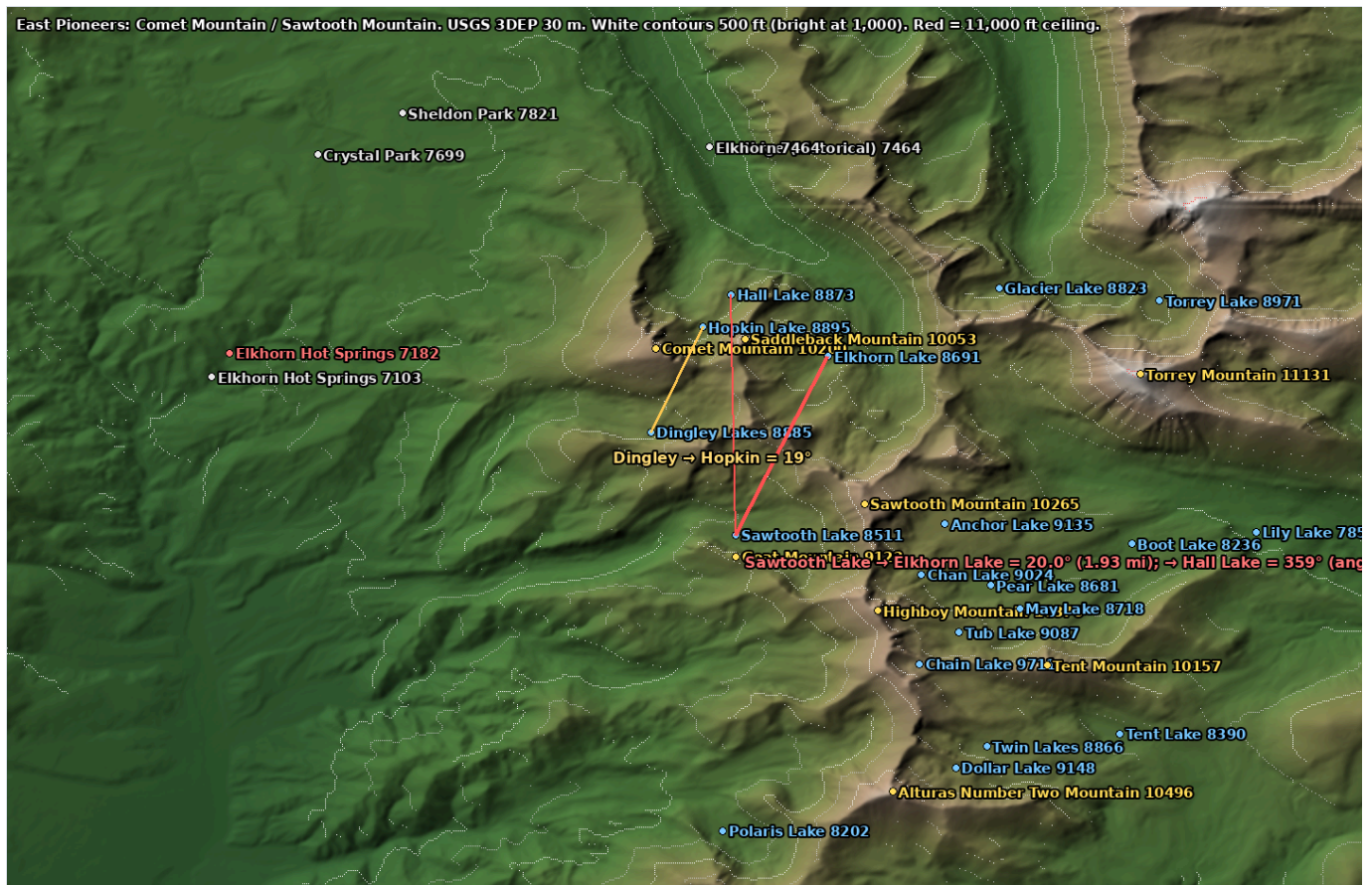
1. **The comet rests on a photo date.** Everything in 2:1 beyond the name is mine until the Instagram photo is shown to be from July 10 to 20, 2020, at Sawtooth Lake.
2. **The Hole has no name.** Every rival solve has a named Hole. This one has a bowl. His "on the nose" punt about hole-named places cuts both ways.
3. **"Three" is unanswered.** See the gap above.
4. **The bride has no face of her own.** The reflection reading gives her one, but it is a reading. He said "bride" is exactly the right word, which suggests something more bridal than a pond.
5. **Wisdom is not in sight from Comet.** The frame only closes if "shadowed sight" means hidden.
6. **It is the crowd's ground.** Searchers have worked Polaris and Crystal Park since 2025 and sent no correct checkpoint photo. Either the checkpoint is subtle or they were on the wrong flank.

THE FALLBACK PATH: SAWTOOTH LAKE

POSEY He built fallback paths. The same poem also walks from Sawtooth Lake: the comet was seen from its shore, Clark Creek makes the only measured 88° bend at its outlet, its cirque is a Hole, it is trout water, and a 20° line from its outlet crosses Saddleback's shoulder to Elkhorn Lake under Comet's east side. It converges on the same mountain from the south. It loses on the exact 20°, which belongs to Dingley, and Sawtooth Lake is 1.95 mi from any road.

WHAT TO DO, IN ORDER

1. Date the 2020 Polaris photo. Fifteen minutes online; changes the whole weight of 2:1.
2. Drive the unnamed road off the Elkhorn Hot Springs side and note where a low car stops. If it reaches 9,540 ft, the mile rule holds for the summit and both bowls.
3. Load the real PAD-US and re-score the north wall, Hopkin's outlet and Dingley's outlet.
4. One day on the mountain: road end, summit, down to Hopkin's outlet. Sight 20° back toward Dingley from there. Photograph the north wall's reflection. Note where the outlet streams go silent under boulders. Then walk to Dingley's outlet and sight 20° forward.
5. Ask the monthly Featured Question: "Is the Hole a bowl?" Specific, not on the nose.



Yellow: Dingley Lakes to Hopkin Lake, the 20° line, drawn on lake centres here; on outlets it is 20.0° exactly. Red: the Sawtooth Lake fallback line.